

Psychedelic Mushrooms

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Psychedelic mushrooms are widely considered to be dangerous and are illegal in many places, including under USA federal law.

Like other illegal drugs such as cocaine and methamphetamine, they are often warned against by law enforcement, educators, and public health organizations because of the risks associated with their use.

As a result, their possession, cultivation, distribution, and use remain heavily restricted in much of the United States and many other countries.

WHAT ARE PSYCHEDELICS?

Psychedelic mushrooms, often called "magic mushrooms," are naturally occurring fungi that contain the psychoactive compounds psilocybin and psilocin.

When consumed, these compounds alter the way the brain processes perception, emotion, and thought, producing a range of mental and physical effects. Users commonly experience visual changes such as brighter colors, moving patterns, or geometric shapes, an altered sense of time, unusual patterns of thinking, heightened emotions, and feelings of connection with nature, other people, or the universe.

Some describe the experience as deeply spiritual or mystical, while higher doses can produce vivid hallucinations and make it difficult to distinguish internal thoughts from external reality.

Physical effects may include dilated pupils, nausea, increased heart rate, slightly elevated blood pressure, dizziness, yawning, and poor coordination. The effects typically begin 20 to 60 minutes after

consumption, peak within one and a half to three hours, and usually last four to eight hours, with some aftereffects continuing into the following day.

HOW DANGEROUS ARE PSYCHEDELICS?

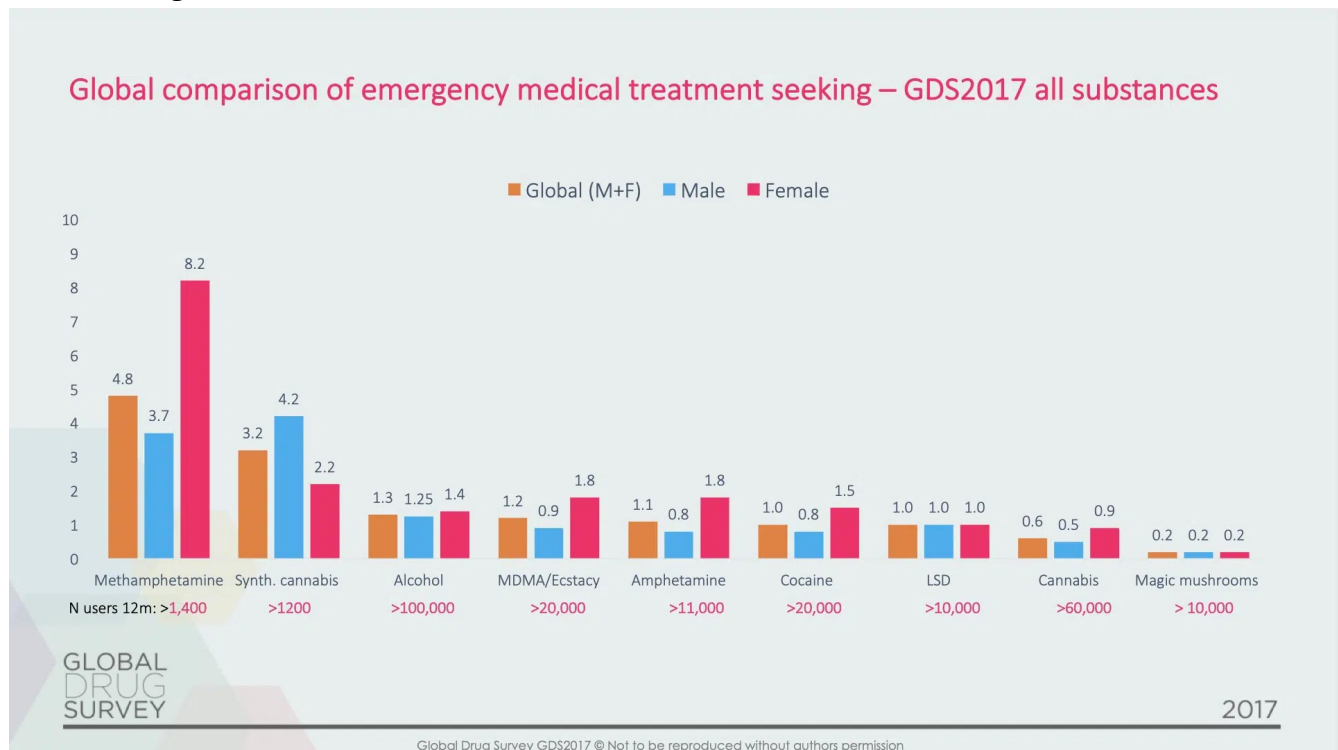
Psychedelic mushrooms are just about the safest drugs out there. Based on the available scientific evidence, psilocybin is considered one of the lowest risk psychoactive drug.

Although, not completely risk free.

PHYSICALLY

There is no established fatal dose of psilocybin in humans, and there are no well-documented cases of a death caused solely by a psilocybin overdose. And psilocybin is not physically addictive. If you were to use psilocybin, you would never find yourself addicted to it. **Psilocybin is not an addictive, nor deadly substance^{C1}.**

Below is a chart^{C2} detailing data collected regarding how often users seek medical treatment on different drugs.



This is not how deadly a drug is, but only how often users of these drugs are compelled to seek medical attention. At the one end, you have 5% of meth users seeking medical attention. And at the other end of the data table, you can psychedelic mushrooms ("magic mushrooms") and 0.2%. That's well below alcohol and weed.

From a physical health standpoint, psilocybin is generally considered one of the safest psychoactive drugs. It has low toxicity, very low addiction potential, and no established lethal dose in humans.

Unlike many other drugs, psilocybin is not known to damage major organs or produce physical dependence. Most physical side effects are temporary and may include nausea, dizziness, increased heart rate, dilated pupils, yawning, and poor coordination.

MENTALLY

While most people report positive experiences, such as increased introspection, emotional insight, or feelings of connectedness. Others can experience anxiety, panic, paranoia, confusion, or an overwhelming "bad trip." These bad trips are not rare. Estimates vary between studies because they depend on the dose, setting, and the especially on the person's mindset going into it.

These reactions are more likely with higher doses, stressful environments, or in individuals with certain mental health conditions.

Psilocybin can also trigger or worsen psychotic symptoms in people who are predisposed to disorders such as schizophrenia or bipolar disorder. And although extremely uncommon, some users have reported visual disturbances after use.

For a healthy adult, temporary unpleasant psychological effects may be fairly common. But serious psychological complications are extremely rare.

CONCLUSION

In conclusion, psilocybin has a relatively favorable safety profile compared to many other psychoactive drugs, particularly regarding physical toxicity and addiction. However, it still carries possible psychological risks and should not be viewed as completely safe.

WHAT ARE THE BENEFITS?

The strongest scientific evidence for psilocybin is in the treatment of depression. Multiple clinical studies have found that one or a few supervised psilocybin sessions can significantly reduce depressive symptoms, including in some people with treatment-resistant depression. Researchers continue to study its long-term effectiveness, but the results so far have been promising.

Psilocybin has also shown strong potential for reducing anxiety, particularly in people with life-threatening illnesses. Clinical trials have found that it can reduce anxiety and depression while improving quality of life and reducing fear surrounding death.

Another promising area of research is addiction treatment. Early studies suggest that psilocybin-assisted therapy may help people quit smoking and reduce alcohol dependence. Researchers are also investigating whether it may be beneficial for treating other substance use disorders.

Many participants in clinical studies report improvements in overall emotional well-being after psilocybin treatment. These include greater life satisfaction, increased gratitude, improved relationships, greater emotional openness, and a more positive outlook on life.

Psilocybin is also well known for producing mystical or spiritual experiences. Many users describe feelings of unity, interconnectedness, profound peace, or a greater sense of meaning and purpose. Research has found that these experiences are often associated with lasting improvements in psychological well-being.

Finally, psilocybin may encourage self-reflection and personal insight. Users commonly report seeing personal problems from new perspectives, recognizing unhealthy habits or thought patterns, and feeling more connected to themselves, others, or nature. While evidence also suggests it may enhance creativity, the research in this area is mixed and less conclusive than for its therapeutic effects.

OVERVIEW

Here's a short concise overview that covers what was explored in this paper.

QUESTION	SHORT ANSWER
Is it addictive?	No, psychedelics are not addictive
Can I overdose?	No, psychedelics are not lethal in any dose
Are there side-effects?	Yes, depending on your attitude going in, you can experience: • Panic attacks or intense fear • Confusion • Impaired decision-making • Triggering psychosis (in people with psychiatric disorders) • Rare, persistent visual disturbances after the experience
Are there benefits?	Yes, many people experience the following: • Reduction in depression • Reduction in anxiety • Freedom from addiction (tobacco, alcohol, and more) • Increasing emotional well-being • Greater life satisfaction • Increased gratitude • Improved relationships • Greater emotional openness • Reduced fear of death • Mystical or spiritual experiences • Increased self-reflection

SOURCES

* Indicates a topic or source that was uncovered with the help of an AI model (ChatGPT, Grok, etc.). The facts and sources themselves are independently studied and verified by the author. No AI model is taken at it's word.

Email LanthanoResearch@protonmail.com if you would like to ask a question, found an error throughout this paper, or have more evidence you would like to present to me (regarding either side of the debate).

HOW DANGEROUS ARE PSYCHEDELICS?

*[C1] Psychedelic risks and dangers and addiction: <https://www.nccih.nih.gov/health/psilocybin-for-mental-health-and-addiction-what-you-need-to-know>; <https://nida.nih.gov/research-topics/psilocybin-magic-mushrooms>

[C2] Global Drug Survey image credit:
https://www.globaldrugsurvey.com/wp-content/themes/globaldrugsurvey/results/GDS2017_key-findings-report_final.pdf

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